

Post-incident review PIR-2025-061

Identity Platform: partial outage

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 05 February 2025, Identity Platform experienced partial outage in production (AU East) for about 40 minutes. The end-to-end checkout probe went red. Investigation found that a DNS record was repointed during a migration while the old target was still serving writes.

Impact

Users of Identity Platform saw partial outage for about 40 minutes. The service owner, Identity and Access, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:01 First signal received.
- 09:27 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:42 Likely cause identified.
- 10:08 Mitigation applied.
- 10:45 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a DNS record was repointed during a migration while the old target was still serving writes.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.
- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.